
Property Due Diligence Checklist

Due diligence is not a mood, it's a list. This is the one we run before any offer goes in. Work top to bottom; anything you can't tick becomes a question for the agent, the vendor or your solicitor — before exchange, not after.

01 The area

- ☐ Sold prices for the street and surrounding roads over the last 24 months (Land Registry, not asking prices)
 - ☐ Current rental listings within a half-mile — how many, how long listed, at what rent
 - ☐ Walk the street at 9am, 3pm and 9pm — a street changes character three times a day
 - ☐ Flood risk on the government flood map, including surface-water risk
 - ☐ Planning applications on the council portal for the street and both neighbours
 - ☐ Article 4 directions or selective licensing schemes covering the postcode
 - ☐ School catchments and Ofsted ratings if the exit or tenant profile is families
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02 The building

- ☐ Construction type and age — anything non-standard flags the lender conversation early
 - ☐ Roofline from the street: sagging ridge, slipped tiles, chimney condition
 - ☐ Damp: smell it on entry, look at skirting level, check behind furniture on external walls
 - ☐ Cracks: hairline is cosmetic; stepped cracking through brickwork gets a structural engineer
 - ☐ Boiler age, service history and location — a replacement is £2–3.5k of your budget
 - ☐ Consumer unit age — an old fuse board usually means a full or partial rewire
 - ☐ Window condition and FENSA certificates for replacements
 - ☐ Loft: insulation depth, daylight through the roof, water tank condition
 - ☐ Signs of Japanese knotweed anywhere on the plot or adjoining land
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03 The legals

- ☐ Tenure — leasehold years remaining, ground rent terms and service charge history
 - ☐ Title plan matches what you walked: boundaries, parking, access
 - ☐ Restrictive covenants that touch your strategy (no business use, no alterations)
 - ☐ Rights of way or shared access across the plot
 - ☐ Building regulations sign-off for any extension or conversion you can see
 - ☐ Gas and electrical certificates if currently tenanted
 - ☐ EPC rating — and what it costs to reach the letting minimum if it's marginal
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04 The numbers

☐ Your maximum price from the deal analysis — set before the viewing, not after

☐ Three genuine rental comparables, phoned and confirmed, not just listed

☐ Refurbishment budget built line by line, plus 15% contingency

☐ All-in acquisition cost: price, stamp duty, legals, survey, finance fees

☐ The deal still works at an interest rate 2% higher than today's quote

☐ Exit tested two ways: what if it won't refinance, what if it won't sell
